

Spanish A1 — Week 11 Student Overview

Crescere | Beginner Spanish | Week 11

Theme: Health and the Body

What You Will Learn This Week

By the end of Week 11, you will be able to:

- Name at least 12 body parts in Spanish with the correct article
- Say where it hurts using *doler* — *me duele la cabeza, me duelen los pies*
- Describe common symptoms — fever, cold, cough, nausea
- Walk into a Spanish-speaking pharmacy, describe what's wrong, and ask for a product
- Give and receive health advice using *deber* and *deberías*
- Say how long something has been going on using *llevar* — *llevo tres días con fiebre*
- Handle a basic doctor's consultation: describe symptoms, explain duration, understand advice

A Structure You Already Know

The most important grammar this week — *doler* — works exactly like *gustar*, which you learned in Week 6 and used again in Week 10.

Gustar (you know this):

- *Me gusta el fútbol.* — I like football. (el fútbol is the subject)
- *Me gustan los deportes.* — I like sport. (los deportes is plural subject → *gustan*)

Doler (same structure, new verb):

- *Me duele la cabeza.* — My head hurts. (la cabeza is the subject)
- *Me duelen los pies.* — My feet hurt. (los pies is plural subject → *duelen*)

The pattern is identical. The body part is the grammatical subject. The verb agrees with the body part — not with the person.

Important: In Spanish, body parts take the **definite article** (*el/la/los/las*), NOT a possessive (*mi/tu*):

- Correct: *Me duele **la** cabeza.* ✓
- Wrong: *Me duele **mi** cabeza.* ✗

The Grammar This Week

Doler — Agreement Table

What hurts	Verb	Example
singular body part	duele	<i>Me duele el estómago.</i>
plural body part	duelen	<i>Me duelen las rodillas.</i>
infinitive phrase	duele	<i>Me duele tragar.</i> (it hurts to swallow)

Deber + Infinitivo — Advice

Deber expresses obligation or advice. *Deberías* is the polite form.

- *Debes descansar.* — You should rest.
- *Deberías beber más agua.* — You should drink more water. (softer, more polite)
- *No debes trabajar esta semana.* — You shouldn't work this week.

Llevar + Time — Duration

Llevar tells you how long something has been going on. It is still happening now.

- *Llevo tres días con fiebre.* — I've had a fever for three days.
- *Llevo una semana tosiendo.* — I've been coughing for a week.
- *Llevo dos días sin dormir bien.* — I haven't slept well for two days.

Structure: *llevar* (conjugated) + time + gerund OR *con* + noun phrase

Example Conversations

At the Pharmacy

You: Buenas tardes. No me encuentro bien. Tengo fiebre desde ayer y me duele la garganta.

Pharmacist: ¿También tiene tos?

You: Sí, llevo tres días tosiendo. ¿Tiene algo para eso?

Pharmacist: Sí, este jarabe es muy bueno para la tos y la garganta. Tome una cucharada tres veces al día, después de las comidas.

You: ¿Necesita receta?

Pharmacist: No, es de venta libre. Son ocho euros.

You: Muchas gracias.

At the Doctor

Doctor: Buenos días. ¿Qué le pasa?

You: No me encuentro bien. Me duele la espalda y tengo fiebre. Llevo cuatro días así.

Doctor: ¿Cuánto tiempo lleva con fiebre exactamente?

You: Llevo cuatro días con fiebre — unos 38 grados.

Doctor: Entiendo. Debes descansar y beber mucha agua. Deberías tomar este medicamento dos veces al día. No debes trabajar esta semana.

You: ¿Es grave?

Doctor: No, no es nada grave. Vuelve en una semana si no mejoras.

Key Vocabulary — Quick Reference

Body Parts

la cabeza · los ojos · la nariz · la boca · la garganta · la oreja · el cuello · el hombro · el brazo · la mano · la espalda · el estómago · la pierna · el pie · la rodilla

Symptoms

tener fiebre · estar resfriado/a · tener tos · tener náuseas · sentirse mal · estar mareado/a · estar cansado/a

Useful Phrases

- *No me encuentro bien.*
 - *Me duele...*
 - *¿Tiene algo para...?*
 - *Debes / Deberías...*
 - *Llevo + time + con / gerund*
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Between Sessions: What to Practice

After Session 21:

- Learn 12 body parts with articles (head to foot)
- Practice the *doler* rule: *duele* (singular) vs. *duelen* (plural)
- Practice your pharmacy scenario aloud three times
- Complete Session 21 homework

After Session 22:

- Write a 6–8 sentence description of a real or imagined illness — include one *me duele*, one *llevo*, and one *deberías*
 - Practice your doctor's appointment scenario from memory
 - Complete Session 22 homework
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A Word About Week 12

Week 12 is the final performance week — two integrated sessions where you demonstrate everything you have learned.

What Week 12 involves:

- A spoken role play (5–7 minutes): meeting someone, exchanging personal information, making a plan, giving directions
- A written message (8–10 sentences): introduce yourself, describe your daily routine, suggest plans

What is expected: Natural, confident communication on familiar topics — not perfection. The goal is to get your meaning across, recover when stuck, and show what you have learned over twelve weeks.

Week 11 helps you get ready in two ways. First, navigating a pharmacy and doctor's appointment builds role-play stamina — by the end of this week, extended conversations in Spanish will feel more natural. Second, *llevar* for duration transfers directly to Week 12: *Llevo tres meses estudiando español* (I've been studying Spanish for three months) is a natural sentence to include in a personal introduction.
